Jessie Yang

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Education

University of California, Berkeley
Bachelors of Science in Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences (May 2019)

Technical Skills

- C++, C#, Python, Java, Unreal Engine, Unity
- Wwise, Perforce, Git, Visual Studio
- JIRA, Miro, Microsoft Office
- Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Procreate

Work Experience

Wildlight Entertainment, Senior Gameplay Engineer, Highguard (Aug 2023 - Feb 2026)

- Shipped *Highguard* (2026)--an online PVP first-person raid shooter built in Unreal Engine 5--on PC, Playstation 5, and Xbox Series X/S with a core team of 20 engineers.
- Partnered with designers to iterate on a player-item interaction system that deduced user intent and resolved potential actions across input, building, looting, and weapon systems.
- Collaborated with audio/VFX designers to design then build systems and tools for emissive audio volumes, dynamic environmental & destruction audio, custom animation notifies, impact tables, etc.
- Designed and implemented infrastructure, assets, and gameplay hooks to enable features like more efficient audio occlusion, shuffleable music playlists, VO subtitles, weapon FX, settings, and more.
- Designed, implemented, and optimized core audio systems, integration with Wwise sound engine, and audio playback APIs. Built bespoke subsystems with some middleware or engine modifications.
- Supported the integration of Vivox voice chat with game layer to enable team and party chat channels, plus muting and blocking features on PC and consoles in compliance with TRCs/XRs.

Blizzard Entertainment, Software Engineer, Gameplay and Features, Overwatch (Jan 2020 - Jul 2023)

- Shipped *Overwatch 2* (2022)--an online PVP first-person team-based hero shooter built in a proprietary ECS engine--on PC, Xbox, Playstation, and Switch with a core team of 60+ engineers.
- Provided gameplay engineering support for a strike team of artists and designers creating the Hero, Venture, through both visual scripting and updates to native engine (C++) movement technologies.
- Collaborated on game mode development for “Starwatch: Galactic Rescue” event through rapid prototyping, engine updates for new gameplay elements, debugging, and other ad hoc support.
- Prototyped flag-plant emote feature. Built asset pipeline. Built and playtested solutions for visibility and combat problems caused by users spawning persistent, cosmetic entities in maps mid-match.
- Shipped dozens of screens and client-side systems for social, progression, and other metagame features in *Overwatch* (2016) and *Overwatch 2*. Employed MVVM design pattern and leveraged C++, proprietary visual and text-based scripting languages, and XML.
- Drove the client-side implementation of *Overwatch 2*’s Battle Pass. Set up server-to-client data pipeline, created bespoke screens and animations, integrated with an existing Hero Gallery, etc.
- Updated client implementation of various live *Overwatch* features to support cross-platform play between PC and consoles as well as ensure console compliance.
- Refactored settings persistence system with asset-driven approach to skip costly code generation.
- Added customizations and quality-of-life features to “Replay Viewer” feature for both regular users and professional esports spectators.

Blizzard Entertainment, Associate Software Engineer, Unannounced Project (July 2019 - Dec 2019)

- Developed end-to-end features for a 4X mobile game prototype built in Unity with C# and C++.
- Fixed bugs in various menus, resource and notification systems, movement, and other features.